

Case Study: Cyberbullying – The Megan Meier Incident

Cyberbullying is a form of online harassment where individuals are threatened, insulted, or humiliated through digital platforms such as social media, messaging apps, or online forums. A widely known real-life example is the case of Megan Meier, a 13-year-old girl from the United States who experienced severe online bullying in 2006 on the social networking site MySpace.

The incident began when Megan received a friend request from a boy named “Josh Evans” on MySpace. At first, the conversations were friendly and supportive. However, after some time the messages suddenly became hostile and insulting. Step-by-step, the situation escalated: first the fake account built trust with Megan, then it started sending cruel messages and spreading negative comments about her. Eventually, one message claimed that people disliked her and that the world would be better without her. Later investigations revealed that the “Josh Evans” profile was actually a fake account created by adults in the neighborhood as a prank that went too far.

Cyberbullying often targets teenagers and young people who are active on social media and may be emotionally vulnerable. Because online messages can spread quickly and anonymously, victims may feel trapped and unable to escape the harassment.

The consequences of cyberbullying can be severe. Victims may suffer emotional distress, anxiety, and loss of confidence. The Megan Meier case drew national attention and sparked discussions about online safety, responsible digital behavior, and the need for stronger cyberbullying awareness and laws.

Source: Reports by the The New York Times on the Megan Meier cyberbullying case (2007).